What the NSRA means for employers and investors

The NSRA keeps the 21% corporate rate, closes narrow corporate loopholes, raises taxes on income above $400,000 and cuts them for the middle class, and it says so in the text. It also cuts the costs business complains about most: health care, slow federal approvals, fragile supply chains, a growing federal debt and the risk of another 2008. This page sets out both columns with the section numbers, so you can do the math for your own company.

What business gets

Lower drug prices in every plan you pay for. Drugs built on federally funded research cannot be priced in the U.S. above the median G7 price, and that ceiling applies to every buyer, private plans included (Sec. 1301). Insulin is capped at $35 a month and essential medicines at $100 a month out of pocket, whatever the insurance (Sec. 1303). Employer family coverage averaged $28,303 in 2026, and workers paid $7,471 of it, so employers carried about $20,800 per family plan. When Milliman modeled a comparable policy for West Health in 2021, extending negotiated drug prices to private insurance under H.R. 3, it estimated employers would pay $195 billion less in premiums from 2023 to 2029. That is an estimate for a different bill, not for the NSRA; no one has yet estimated the NSRA's effect on employer premiums.

Source: Bill Secs. 1301, 1303; KFF Employer Health Benefits Survey, Oct. 22, 2026; West Health / Milliman, May 20, 2021

Coverage for workers, with no employer mandate. The Basic Minimum Plan is open to working-age adults without affordable employer coverage, and to every uninsured child, through private insurers on the existing exchanges (Secs. 2102, 2104). The bill adds no employer mandate. It leaves employer plans and their tax exclusion untouched, and employers may offer cheaper plans that wrap around the BMP for workers enrolled in it (Sec. 2105(e)).

Source: Bill Secs. 2102, 2104(d), 2105(e)

Federal approvals on a fixed clock. For infrastructure projects of $50 million or more financed through the bill's investment fund, deadline extensions for federal review are capped at one year unless the sponsor agrees, every federal approval goes on one public schedule, and lawsuits must be filed within 150 days (Sec. 1707). Hydropower licensing and relicensing move to a fixed schedule (Sec. 1704). Environmental, safety and labor standards are unchanged.

Source: Bill Secs. 1704, 1707

Investment the private sector can join. Public infrastructure capital requires private or state co-investment of at least $1 for every federal $1 in manufacturing and energy, with a target of $3 private for every $1 public (Sec. 007). Semiconductor and critical-materials investment runs at $15 billion a year (Sec. 1204). At least 80% of the active ingredients in essential generic drugs must be made in the U.S. within five years, with $2 billion to build the plants (Sec. 1302). The government may not take ownership stakes in private companies except to recover fraud, and must sell any such stake to a domestic private buyer (Sec. 2001(a)).

Source: Bill Secs. 007, 1204, 1302, 2001(a)

A level field against offshore profit shifting. The U.S. adopts the 15% global minimum tax agreed to by 140 countries, including a domestic minimum tax so the U.S., not a foreign treasury, collects first (Sec. 2411). Companies that pay their taxes here stop competing against ones that book profits in tax havens. The carbon fee carries a border adjustment so domestic producers are not undercut by imports from countries without one (Sec. 2410).

Source: Bill Secs. 2410, 2411

Protection against another 2008. From the third quarter of 2007 to the first quarter of 2009, U.S. household net worth fell $16 trillion, 24%. The Dallas Fed put the cost of the crisis at $6 trillion to $14 trillion of lost output, $50,000 to $120,000 for every household. The bill sets a mortgage underwriting floor, makes lenders keep at least 5% of the loans they securitize, holds the largest banks' leverage ratios at their January 1, 2025 levels, brings private credit into the stress tests and reporting, and limits credit-rating conflicts (Secs. 1605 to 1611). Those rules protect asset values, and most of the wealth lost in a crisis is held by the people with the most of it.

Source: Bill Secs. 1605-1611; Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, Staff Paper No. 20, July 2013

Customers with more to spend. The 12% income-tax bracket drops to 10%, about $85 billion a year, recaptured from incomes above $400,000 (Sec. 2421). In our run of the open-source OG-USA model, households up to about the 90th percentile of lifetime income spend more in Year 1, and households up to the 70th percentile still spend more in Year 10. Retailers, homebuilders and consumer brands sell to those households.

Source: Bill Sec. 2421; NSRA run of OG-USA 0.6.2, published at /data/open-scoring/og-usa/

Less federal debt. In the same model run, federal debt is about 4 points of GDP lower by Year 10 and 13 points lower by Year 20.

Source: NSRA run of OG-USA 0.6.2, published at /data/open-scoring/og-usa/

What business pays (tax years after 2027)

Item	What changes	Section
Corporate income tax	The rate stays at 21%. The base is broadened: the foreign-derived income deduction, LIFO inventory accounting for larger firms, and oil and gas expensing and percentage depletion end; half of advertising costs are amortized over five years.	Sec. 2409
Global minimum tax	15% minimum on multinationals with revenue above EUR 750 million.	Sec. 2411
Stock buybacks	Excise tax rises from 1% to 4%.	Sec. 2420(d)

Item	What changes	Section
Trading	0.1% on stock and bond trades and 0.01% on derivatives, plus a 0.02% fee on institutional trades over $1 million. Retirement accounts and individual investors with under $1 million in brokerage assets are exempt.	Secs. 2405, 2413
Large financial firms	15% of profit above a 12% return on equity. Institutions under $10 billion in assets are exempt.	Sec. 2415
Carbon fee	$40 a ton, indexed to inflation, with a border adjustment on imports.	Sec. 2410
Paid leave	0.4% of wages from employers, matched by workers. Employers with an equal or better plan of their own pay less.	Sec. 3802(e), (h)
High incomes	39.6% rate above $400,000 single / $450,000 joint; the 3.8% tax on investment income extends to active business income above $400,000 / $500,000; capital gains and dividends above $1 million taxed as ordinary income; Social Security tax on wages above $400,000.	Secs. 2408, 2420
Private equity	Carried interest taxed as ordinary income; interest deductions on leveraged buyouts capped.	Secs. 2402, 2403

Small and mid-size business

- Businesses with under $10 million in revenue are exempt from every Covered Entity obligation in the bill (Sec. 003(3)).
- The corporate rate and base changes apply only to C corporations. S corporations, partnerships and sole proprietorships are untouched by them, and the inventory and advertising changes do not apply to firms under the small-business gross-receipts test (Sec. 2409(g)).
- The excess-profits assessment exempts banks under $10 billion in assets (Sec. 2415).
- Small businesses get 60 days of free compliance help before any penalty, reduced penalties under $10 million in revenue, and an appeal to the SBA's Office of Advocacy (Sec. 2001(c)).
- Firms under $25 million in revenue, worker cooperatives and community lenders can apply for Main Street capital grants (Secs. 003(10), 204).

Rules you can plan around

Every rule here is written into statute with an effective date, a phase-in and a right to notice and appeal before anything is taken (Title XVIII). Required sales are at appraised market value with Court of Federal Claims review. Rules written that way are easier to plan around than rules that change with each administration or each enforcement priority.

The cost, in our own numbers

Our own model shows what this costs. GDP is about 1.9% lower in Year 1, 1.8% lower in Year 10 and 1.5% lower in Year 20, and business investment is lower than it would otherwise be through Year 20 (4.7% lower in Year 1, 2.0% lower in Year 20), mainly because the bill puts more money in families' hands instead of paying down debt faster. In Year 10, households in the top 1% consume about 2% to 11% less than they otherwise would. The model counts lower drug prices and the productivity of roads and research, but not a lower risk of a financial crisis. CBO has not scored the bill.

Sources: KFF, 2026 Employer Health Benefits Survey (Oct. 22, 2026); West Health Policy Center and Milliman, Commercial Savings Generated by Medicare Negotiation Under H.R. 3 (May 20, 2021); Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, How Bad Was It? The Costs and Consequences of the 2007-09 Financial Crisis, Staff Paper No. 20 (July 2013); NSRA run of OG-USA, TheAmericanDeal.org/data/open-scoring/og-usa. An independent project of Santonio D. Sanders. Fiscal figures are model estimates; official CBO and JCT scoring is pending.